

Kennedy Johnston

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Texas A&M University | Department of Economics | College Station, TX 77843

Education

Texas A&M University

Doctor of Philosophy (Ph.D.) in Economics (in progress)

Dissertation Committee: Danila Serra (Chair), Catherine Eckel, Jonathan Meer, Laura Dague

College Station, TX

Expected May 2027

University of Nebraska-Lincoln

Bachelor of Science in Business Administration

Major: Economics (Honors); Minor: Mathematics

Lincoln, NE

May 2022

Research Fields

Crime; Gender; Behavioral and Experimental

Working Papers

The Under-Reporting of Sexual Assault: An Experiment on Victims, Perpetrators, and Social Judgment 2026

[Link to Paper.](#)

[Pre-Registered on the AEA RCT Registry: AEARCTR-0015001]

Shaping Major Choice: The Role of High School Counselors 2026

(with Jonathan Meer and Danila Serra)

[Link to Paper.](#)

[Pre-Registered on the AEA RCT Registry: AEARCTR-0004320]

Works in Progress

A Crime with Little Punishment? The Likelihood of Arrest Following A Sexual Assault Report 2026

Returns to College Grades 2026

(with Jonathan Meer)

The Impacts of Campus Violence: Evidence from College School Shootings 2026

(with Nathan Wise)

Sexual Assault Reporting Platforms and Social Norms: Insights from Callisto Users and an Online Experiment 2025

[Pre-Registered on the AEA RCT Registry: AEARCTR-0016107]

Grants and Fellowships

Arnold Ventures (planning grant) – \$97,387

(with Danila Serra)

Fall 2024

John Van Huyck Fellowship – \$5,000

Fall 2024

Aviles-Johnson Graduate Fellowship – Annual Stipend, Tuition, and Fees *Fall 2022*

Other Scholarships and Honors

Gail Frey Monson Memorial Scholarship – \$500 *Fall 2026*

MH Webber Scholarship – \$2,500 *Fall 2025*

Presentations

Freiburg Ph.D. Workshop on the Economics of Criminal Behavior (Planned), Germany *2026*

Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting (Planned), San Antonio, TX *2026*

The Virtual Crime Economics (ViCE) Seminar Series (Planned) *2026*

Texas Economics of Crime Workshop (TxECW), Austin, TX *2026*

North-American Economic Science Association (ESA) Conference, Tucson, AZ *2025*

Annual Texas Experimental Association Symposium (TExAS), Waco, TX *2025*

Research Experience

Research Assistant

Drs. Jonathan Meer and Danila Serra, Texas A&M University *Spring 2024 – present*

Dr. Danila Serra, Texas A&M University *Summer 2023*

Dr. Daniel Tannenbaum, University of Nebraska-Lincoln *Summer 2022*

Drs. Ann Mari May and Daniel Tannenbaum, University of Nebraska-Lincoln *Summer 2019*

Teaching Experience

ECON440: Experimental Economics

Instructor of Record at Texas A&M University *Summer 2025*

ECON441: Policy Economics

Teaching Assistant for Dr. Danila Serra at Texas A&M University *Spring 2024*

ECMT461: Economic Data Analysis

Teaching Assistant for Dr. Craig Schulman at Texas A&M University *Fall 2023, Fall 2025*

ECON421: Economics of Crime

Teaching Assistant for Dr. Chelsea Strickland at Texas A&M University *Fall 2022, Spring 2023*

Referee Experience

Journal of Policy Analysis and Management

Professional Service

Economic Graduate Student Association

Second Year Representative *College Station, TX*
August 2023 – May 2024

Department of Economics, Texas A&M University

First-Year Ph.D. Student Mentor *College Station, TX*
August 2023 – May 2024

References

Danila Serra (Chair)

Associate Professor

Department of Economics

Texas A&M University

dserra@tamu.edu

Catherine Eckel

Sara and Jon Lindsey Professor

University Distinguished Professor

Department of Economics

Texas A&M University

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Jonathan Meer

Department Head

*Mary Julia and George R. Jordan Professor
of Public Policy*

Department of Economics

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Laura Dague

James M. Griffin Professor of Health Policy

Department of Public Service and
Administration

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